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Rolling Utility Cart

Source: IKEA official product page and teacher organization blogs that document its common use in classrooms (IKEA, 2025; Growing Little Minds, 2017).

45 CREATIVE WAYS TO USE AN IKEA RÅSKOG CART



(<https://momenvy.co/creative-ways-raskog-cart/>)

Details

The rolling utility cart is a popular three-tier cart made of metal or plastic. It features open shelves that teachers can move around the classroom to different student groups or stations. Supplies can be stored in bins or placed directly on the shelves for easy access during lessons.

Analysis

The cart is great for mobility and helps save time during group work. However, the open shelves make it easy for supplies to be taken without being returned, knocked over, or damaged. There is no locking mechanism or check-out system, leading to lost materials and unequal access, especially in classrooms where students share supplies. This can result in lost instructional time and theft.

Prior Design Attempt #2 – Over-the-Door Shoe Organizer

Source: Teacher organization blogs and vendor product listings on Amazon that show classroom adaptations (TeacherNyla, 2025; MoneySavingMom, 2011).



(<https://www.amazon.com/caralin-Hanging-Organizer-Teaching-Classroom/dp/B0D9LV2P81>)

Details

This fabric hanging rack with 12–40 clear pockets hangs over a door or on a wall. Teachers place small shared supplies in the see-through pockets so students can quickly see and grab what they need without opening drawers.

Analysis

It saves floor space and makes supplies visible, which helps younger students find items faster. However, the open pockets offer no security—students can remove items without returning them, and there is no protection from damage or a tracking system. In classrooms with high reliance on shared materials, supplies still disappear quickly, failing to address the core problems of missing or stolen items and lost class time.

Prior Design Attempt #3 – Stacking Plastic Drawers

Source: Sterilite official manufacturer website and teacher organization blogs documenting classroom use (Sterilite, n.d.; Teaching With Terhune, 2019).



(<https://mrsterhune.blogspot.com/2018/06/classroom-organization-storage-ideas.html>)

Details

These models clear plastic drawers stack to create a supply station. Each drawer holds one type of material (e.g., pencils in one, scissors in another), keeping items sorted and visible through the clear fronts.

Analysis

The clear design allows easy viewing and helps keep the classroom neat. However, most models do not include locks, so students can open drawers freely, take extra items, or mix up supplies. Without any check-out or accountability feature, materials continue to go missing or get damaged, which does not solve the daily issue of unreliable access for students who depend on classroom stock.

Prior Design Attempt #4 – Supply Caddy

Source: Lakeshore Learning official vendor website for classroom products (Lakeshore Learning, n.d.).



(<https://www.lakeshorelearning.com/products/teaching-resources/bins-organizers/neon-classroom-supply-caddy-bright-orange/s/TT304BO/>)

Details

Small plastic caddies with 4–6 divided sections sit directly on desks or tables. They hold basic shared supplies so student groups can access them quickly without leaving their seats during lessons.

Analysis

These caddies greatly improve speed of access during group work and reduce student movement around the room. However, the open compartments provide no security or protection—items are easy to take, break, or lose. In classes where many students lack personal supplies, materials disappear fast with no tracking, so the design does not prevent theft, damage, or the resulting lost instructional time and frustration.

These prior attempts improve basic visibility and access but consistently lack security features and accountability systems. They do not adequately protect shared materials from going missing, being stolen, or getting damaged—especially when many students depend on limited classroom supplies. A stronger solution needs a locking option and simple check-out process while remaining affordable and student-friendly.